

Placement Simulator - Interview Report

Role: SDE

Category: system-design

Difficulty: easy

Scores

overall: 86/100

technical: 86/100

communication: 90/100

confidence: 90/100

problemSolving: 85/100

coding: 0/100

Strengths

- Clear understanding of caching layers and appropriate data candidates
- Comprehensive identification of functional and non functional requirements for a URL shortener
- Reasoned approach to choosing between relational and document databases based on data characteristics

Weaknesses

- Limited discussion of cache invalidation strategies and consistency models
- Missing details on ID generation, collision handling, and analytics for the URL shortener
- No mention of database schema design, indexing, or scaling strategies for the chosen database

Suggestions

- Include cache invalidation patterns (TTL, write through, cache aside) and discuss consistency trade offs
- Explain how to generate unique short URLs, handle collisions, and store click analytics
- Describe database schema, indexing, and sharding/replication plans for the selected database

Summary

The candidate demonstrates solid foundational knowledge in caching, system requirements, and database selection, with clear communication and confidence. However, deeper technical details—such as cache invalidation, URL collision handling, and database scaling—are missing. Strengthening these areas would elevate the candidate to a stronger placement level.